

Cover Letter

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I am writing to express my interest in the Graduate Assistant position with the Department of Technology, Leadership, & Design at Mississippi State University. As a current Ph.D. student in Computer Science at Mississippi State University with an M.S. in Computer Science and more than four years of professional experience in data science, analytics, software development, and technical communication, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to the department's recruitment, outreach, and student engagement efforts.

Although my academic background is in Computer Science, much of my professional experience has involved communicating information in clear and engaging ways. In my previous roles as a Data Scientist and Data Analyst, I developed reports, interactive visualizations, dashboards, and analytical content to communicate complex information to different audiences. At Lighthouse ERP, I used Python, Power BI, Matplotlib, and other visualization tools to identify trends and transform analytical results into understandable insights. I also developed a React.js and FastAPI-based analytics application, which required me to think carefully about how information should be organized and presented for users.

My experience at AdvonCommerce and HCLTech further strengthened my communication and organizational skills. I created reports and interactive visualizations to communicate key metrics and actionable insights, conducted A/B testing to evaluate user engagement, and collaborated with cross-functional teams to manage projects and meet deadlines. At HCLTech, I also worked extensively with reporting, data visualization, Excel, Tableau, and project coordination. These experiences have taught me how to organize information, identify the most meaningful points for an audience, and present those points in a clear and compelling manner.

I am particularly interested in this position because of its emphasis on telling the stories of students, faculty, programs, and alumni. I believe my technical background gives me a valuable perspective for communicating the impact of technology and academic programs to prospective students. I enjoy learning about people's experiences, identifying meaningful information, and turning complex ideas into content that is easier for others to understand. As a graduate student at Mississippi State University, I would also be excited to help prospective students better understand the opportunities, experiences, and community available at the university.

In addition to my professional experience, my academic and research work has required strong written communication, organization, attention to detail, and the ability to explain technical concepts to different audiences. My research in machine learning, cybersecurity, and edge computing has involved analyzing information, preparing research content, and communicating technical findings. I would bring the same attention to detail and commitment to clear communication to the department's social media, recruitment, outreach, and event-related activities.

I am a creative, organized, and detail-oriented individual who is comfortable learning new tools and taking responsibility for projects independently. I would welcome the opportunity to develop my skills in higher education communication, digital content, recruitment, and student engagement while contributing to the Department of Technology, Leadership, & Design.

Thank you for considering my application. I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss how my background in data-driven communication, technology, and project coordination could contribute to the department's outreach and recruitment efforts. I have attached my resume for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Priya Ajay Deshmukh